

HOUSE No.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Adam J. Scanlon

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to no-cost calls for incarcerated individuals.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Adam J. Scanlon</i>	<i>14th Bristol</i>	<i>10/30/2025</i>

HOUSE No.

By Representative Scanlon of North Attleborough, a petition (subject to Joint Rule 12) of Adam J. Scanlon relative to no-cost calls for incarcerated individuals. Public Safety and Homeland Security.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to no-cost calls for incarcerated individuals.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 127 is hereby amended by striking out section 87A and inserting in place thereof
2 the following section:-

3 Section 87A. (a) For the purposes of this section, the terms "state correctional facility",
4 "state prison" and "county correctional facility" shall have the same meanings as those terms are
5 defined in section 1 of chapter 125.

6 (b) The department of correction and sheriffs shall provide any person committed to a
7 state correctional facility, state prison or county correctional facility, including a jail or house of
8 correction, with voice communication services, including phone calls, free of charge to the
9 person initiating and the person receiving the communication; provided that the department of
10 correction and sheriffs shall provide an opportunity for persons in their custody to the extent
11 possible a minimum of 15 minutes each day but no more than 60 minutes each day as determined
12 individually in the discretion of the commissioner of the department of correction and the

13 sheriffs of each county for their respective facilities; provided further, that the department of
14 correction and sheriffs shall ensure adequate infrastructure for voice communication services;
15 and provided further, that nothing in this section shall prohibit in-person contact visits.

16 (c) The department of correction and sheriffs may supplement voice communication
17 services with other communication services, including, but not limited to, video and electronic
18 communication services; provided, however, that other communication services shall not replace
19 voice communication services; and provided further, that other communication services shall be
20 provided free of charge to the person initiating and the person receiving the communication.